

Two to Tango

The right mouse and keyboard work together to take the stress off your fingers. We tested four lethal combinations to help you make the right choice

A keyboard and mouse combination is meant as the one-stop solution for the discerning and wallet heavy user segment. These bundles are ergonomic, good to look at and fall within the price bracket of Rs 3,500 to Rs 6,500. Some of these boards aim to offer a complete solution—a wireless, optical keyboard and mouse combination. We tested four such combination packages.

Digit Test Process

The keyboard and mouse combos were tested on four primary parameters: Features, Ergonomics, Build quality and Value for money. Each parameter was allotted a 25 per cent weightage. The weightage allotted to each parameter was used to calculate the overall scores.

Features: The interface of the keyboard, the number of hotkeys, whether it was wireless or corded, the presence of integrated scrolling devices or trackballs were all taken into consideration. The accuracy of the mouse under Photoshop and gaming was the primary feature consideration. An optical mouse obviously scored higher; similarly cordless and USB pairings were put on a pedestal.

Ergonomics: Comfort was given equal importance in both the mouse and the keyboard. While the keyboard also rated on the layout of the keys, the tactile feedback and a palm rest, the mouse was primarily awarded for being symmetrical, for providing a

good grip to the palm and a good traction to the surface on which it was placed.

Build Quality: Keyboards were tested on the basis of sturdiness and the stability of the buttons and of the unit as a whole, whereas the mice were dropped from a height of 6 feet and checked for physical damage. The quality and stability of buttons that come along with such a pointing device was also tested against each other on the basis of sturdiness and the stability of the buttons and of the unit as a whole.

PRODUCTS

LOGITECH CORDLESS FREEDOM OPTICAL



MERCURY CORDLESS KEYBOARD AND MOUSE KOB 30210



MICROSOFT WIRELESS DESKTOP



TYPHOON ITEK RF@MOUSE AND KEYBOARD



Logitech Cordless Freedom Optical

Features: 20 hotkeys, USB interface, package includes a palm rest and a cordless optical mouse Price: Rs 6,950 Contact: Rashi Peripherals Phone: 022-2826 0258 E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com Web site: www.logitech.com

The Logitech Cordless Freedom is a wireless set that eliminates line-of-sight restrictions by working in the radio frequency band. The set packs in a cordless keyboard, a cordless optical mouse and a suitable receiver. The keyboard has an excellent layout and works perfectly with all applications. Although it remains responsive at a distance of 20 feet, the mouse (Logitech Cordless MouseMan Optical) misses signals and is generally not as responsive. The set is both good looking and feature packed—the keyboard comes with 20 hotkeys for Internet and multimedia applications and a handy on-board scroll button. The bundled mouse is a bit heavy but works very smoothly. Moreover, the Logitech MouseWare Control Centre lets the user define shortcut keys for both the extra button and the centre button.

Logitech Freedom		A-
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Mercury Cordless Keyboard & Mouse KOB 30210

Features: 19 hotkeys, PS/2 interface, package includes a palm rest and a cordless scroll mouse Price: Rs 2,000 Contact: Kobian India Ltd Phone: 080-5566626 E-mail: rohit@kobian.com Web site: www.kobian.com

The KOB 30210 is a cordless bundle of mouse and keyboard that operates on radio frequency. The design of both the constituents has been kept very simple. The keys are placed in the standard layout while the shortcut keys are arranged in one line, giving the board a very plain look. Shockingly, the keyboard does not have on-board LEDs for [Caps Lock], [Num lock] and [Scroll Lock]—an unfortunate omission. The keyboard offers decent build quality and the keys are quite enough while in use. It requires three AA batteries to work, which adds to the weight of the keyboard and increases its running cost. The mouse bundled is a cordless two-button scroll mouse which works fine with most applications and from a distance of over 6 feet.

Mercury KOB 30210		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	